

Practical II

Study, draw, label and write short notes on the following
External feature of Scoliodon (dog-fish)

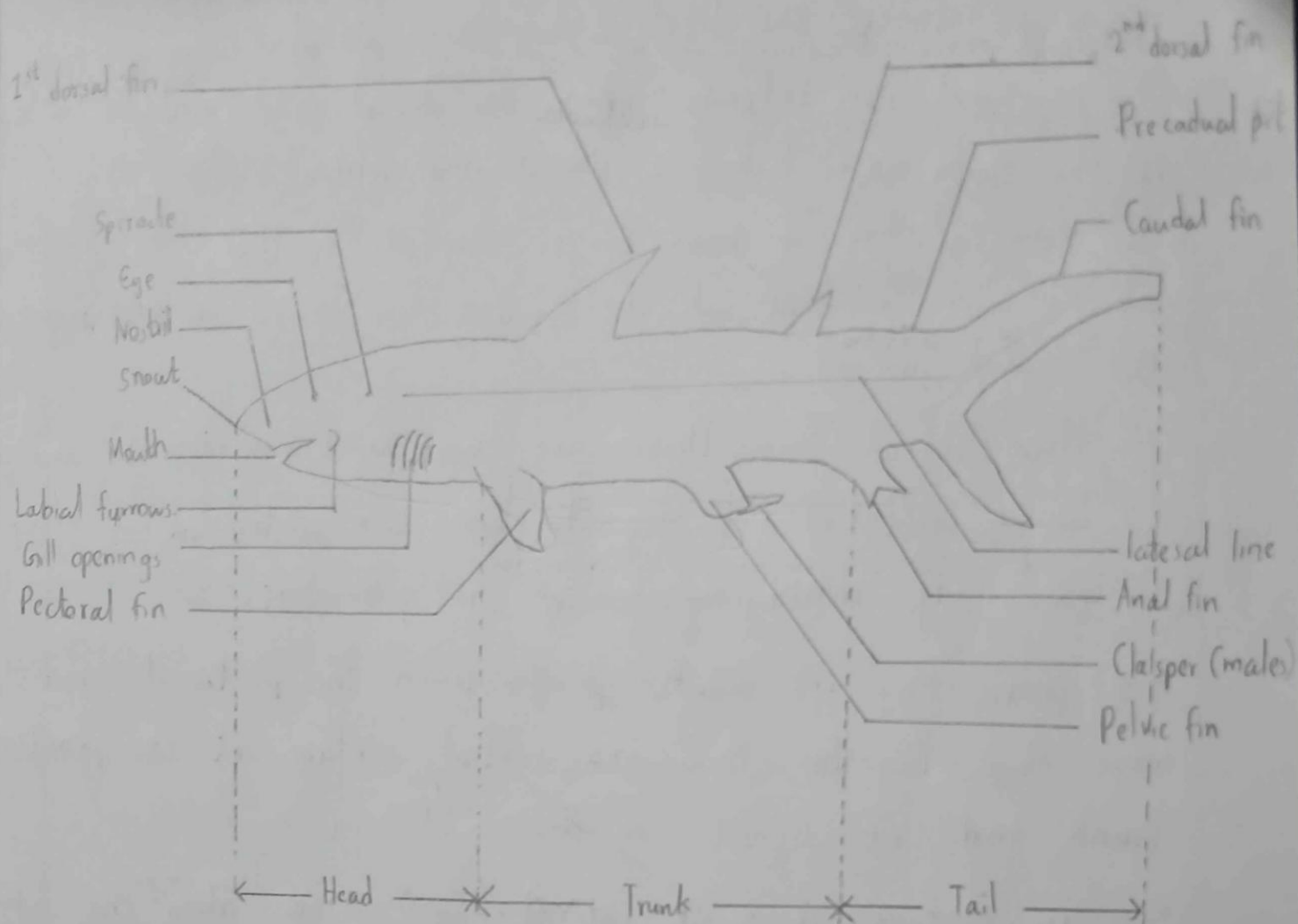
Phylum - Chordata

Class - Elasmobranchi

Order - Lamiformes

Genus - Scoliodon

- Scoliodon is commonly called as dog-fish.
- The body is long, laterally compressed and spindle-shaped tapering at both ends.
- Scoliodon measures below 30 to 60 cm in length.
- The colour of the body is dark grey on the dorsal and lateral surfaces while it is pale on the ventral surface.
- The body is divisible into head, trunk and tail.
- Head: Dorsoventrally compressed, with a long, flattened, spade-shaped snout.
- Eyes: Prominent circular eyes with protective eyelids and nictitating membranes.
- Nostils: Obliquely placed, used for olfaction.
- Mouth: A ventral, crescentic aperture with sharp, backwardly directed teeth.
- Gill slits: Five pairs of vertical gill slits are located on the sides of the head.
- Scales - covered in placoid scales.
- The median fins comprise the two dorsals, a caudal and a ventral or anal fin.
- The first dorsal fin is triangular in shape and situated a little in front of the middle of the body.



Scoliodon

- The second dorsal fin is also triangular but very small and situated mid-way between the first dorsal and the tail.
- The caudal fin extends along the dorsal and ventral surfaces of the tail and forms a dorsal and ventral lobe.
- The ventral fin or anal fin is situated in the mid-ventral line about 5cm in front of the caudal fin, more or less opposite the second dorsal.
- Of the lateral fins, there are two pairs: pectorals and pelvics.
- The large pectoral fins originate from the ventro-lateral margins of the body immediately behind the gill-clefts.
- The pelvic fins are much smaller than the pectorals and arise close together from the ventral surface at the junction of trunk and tail.
- Sensory system: A faint lateral line extends along the sides for detecting vibrations.
- Cloaca: A median-opening located between the pelvic fins.